

Meridian Grid — Recruiter Screen

Operations Lead · 30-min video call · recruiter: J. Doe

FRAMING: First filter, not a deep dive. **Objective:** clear the screen and book the hiring-manager round. **Angles, in order:** (1) plant-floor credibility · (2) the scrap-reduction story · (3) calm on the relocation question. **Hard rules:** never name a salary floor · never volunteer the failed 2019 project unprompted.

1 · "TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF"

"Process engineer, eight years across two plants. The thread: **I find where a line loses time or money, prove it with data, and fix it so it stays fixed** — the changeover program at Northfield cut 31% across four lines. I'm talking to you because this role is the closest match to that craft I've seen in months."

► ~60 seconds. Land the bolded thread sentence slowly; everything else can flex.

2 · "WHY ARE YOU LEAVING?"

"Honest answer: I've taken CI at Northfield as far as the current investment cycle allows. **I want a bigger problem, not a different employer brand.** Meridian's multi-site scope is exactly that."

► End forward-looking. Never criticize the current plant's management.

3 · SALARY

"I'd rather anchor on the role first — **what range did you have in mind for this one?**"

► Say the line, then stop talking. If pushed twice, give the researched range, never the floor.

POWER PHRASES — ONE AT A TIME, THEN LET IT BREATHE

- "I fix it so it stays fixed." — **USE:** whenever standardization comes up.
- "Data first, shop floor second, opinion last." — **USE:** on how I work.

YOUR QUESTIONS FOR THEM (RANKED)

1. "What does the hiring manager most want this person to take off their plate in the first six months?"
2. "What's the next step after this call, and the timeline?"

THE ONE CONCRETE ASK TO LAND BEFORE HANGING UP

"From what I've heard this is a strong match — I'd love to get time with the hiring manager. What do you need from me to set that up?"

Tone: calm = senior. Answer first, caveat second. You belong in this conversation.